

INSIDE THE INDUSTRY

ZILLOW TRIED TO PAY COMPASS OVER A BILLION DOLLARS A YEAR.

To end private listings. Compass said no.

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AN MLS CEO TESTIFIED A TECH EXECUTIVE THREATENED HER PERSONALLY.

Dump her phone. Publish her texts. Millions in litigation.
Under oath, this week, in a Chicago federal courtroom.

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THE CASE: ZILLOW VS. MRED AND COMPASS.

Two days of testimony wrapped Wednesday in front of Judge John Tharp Jr. Compass CEO Robert Reffkin took the stand. So did MRED CEO Rebecca Jensen.

\$1.3 TO \$1.6 BILLION. A YEAR.

That's what Reffkin testified Zillow offered Compass to stop keeping listings off Zillow. Reffkin turned it down.

THEN JENSEN TESTIFIED ABOUT THE CALL.

A Zillow executive told her to expect her phone dumped, her texts made public, millions spent on litigation, and a public spectacle. She refused anyway.

A BILLION DOLLARS A YEAR IS WHAT DISTRIBUTION IS WORTH RIGHT NOW.

Compass said no anyway. The MLS is standing with Compass. The biggest brokerage in the country and the MLS, aligned against the biggest portal.

YOUR LISTINGS ARE WHAT'S BEING FOUGHT OVER.

The ruling could land within weeks of these post-hearing briefs.

WHAT TO DO RIGHT NOW:

- 1** Chicagoland agents: read every listing agreement you sign this month.
- 2** Get it in writing which portals your seller's home actually shows up on.
- 3** Everywhere else: watch this ruling. It's the model going national.

THE TAKEAWAY

PULL THE LAST LISTING AGREEMENT YOU SIGNED AND CHECK WHETHER IT NAMES THE PORTALS THE HOME SHOWS UP ON. IF IT DOESN'T, THAT IS THIS WEEK'S FIX.

A billion dollars a year is what your listings are worth to a portal. Read the agreement like it.

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